

WhisperNotes

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Product and Customer Need

WhisperNotes is an AI-powered note-taking and learning assistant designed for university students who attend lecture-based courses and are evaluated primarily through exams, quizzes, and written assignments. The application records lectures, synchronizes the spoken content with uploaded slides, and automatically generates structured summaries, flashcards, and quizzes aligned with course objectives. Unlike generic transcription tools such as Otter.ai or Notta.ai, WhisperNotes applies academic intelligence to identify key topics, examples, and exam cues, ensuring that lecture material is transformed into organized, exam-ready notes rather than raw text.

The customer pain points this product addresses are well-defined and substantial. Students report difficulty focusing on lectures while simultaneously taking notes, leading to incomplete or disorganized content that must later be rewritten. Many rely on a patchwork of handwritten notes, screenshots, and recordings. These fragmented resources hinder effective exam preparation and force students to spend hours consolidating materials rather than practicing or engaging with content conceptually. WhisperNotes directly alleviates these frictions by automating note organization and reducing cognitive load during class time, while preserving privacy through local or offline data processing.

Preliminary interviews and in-class feedback confirmed that students perceive value in a solution that blends transcription, intelligent summarization, and interactive study tools. The product therefore aligns strongly with the *jobs-to-be-done* framework, where the student's "job" is not merely to record information but to transform lectures into usable learning artifacts. WhisperNotes accomplishes this more efficiently than existing alternatives and thus creates measurable incremental value.

Data Collected and Analysis Conducted

To validate these assumptions and quantify willingness to pay, a survey and Choice-Based Conjoint (CBC) analysis were conducted among forty-one university students. Respondents were first asked about their current note-taking behavior, prior use of digital transcription tools, and their likelihood of adopting an AI-based note-taking application. The results reveal clear evidence of unmet demand.

Approximately 39 percent of respondents reported taking handwritten notes, 34 percent used laptops or tablets, and 27 percent rarely took notes at all. Only 39 percent had ever used a digital transcription or note-taking application such as Otter.ai or Notta.ai. Despite this limited prior exposure, adoption intent was strong: nearly 78 percent indicated they were either "likely" or "very likely" to try an AI-powered note-

taking tool like WhisperNotes. The mean response on a four-point scale was 3.0, suggesting broad openness even among those who have not yet adopted digital note-taking tools.

The conjoint analysis was designed around four key attributes: Summary Quality, Slide Synchronization, Sample Quiz Generation, and Price (levels: Free, \$4.99, \$9.99, \$14.99). Each participant evaluated multiple product bundles to reveal their underlying preferences and trade-offs. Using the estimation logic as per *Measuring Preferences*, utilities were derived for each attribute level. The price coefficient provides the scale to translate utilities into dollar values.

From the conjoint outputs, the change in total utility between “Free” and “\$14.99” was approximately 219 (95.72 + 123.28) utils. Applying the class formula,

$$1 \text{ util} = \frac{14.99 \text{ USD}}{219 \text{ utils}} \approx \$0.0684 \text{ per util.}$$

- Summary Quality (No Summary vs Summary + Flashcards): +60.49 utils → \$4.14 of perceived value
- Slide Synchronization (Present vs Absent): +38.31 utils → \$2.62 of perceived value
- Sample Quiz Generation (Present vs Absent): +33.82 utils → \$2.31 of perceived value

The cumulative differentiation value relative to a baseline note-taking app without these features is therefore roughly \$8–\$9 per month. This represents the total incremental monthly surplus created for the customer across all enhanced functions.

Using the EVC framework, WhisperNotes’ *Economic Value to the Customer* can thus be expressed as:

$$\text{EVC} = \text{Competitor Price} + \text{Differentiation Value}$$

Component	Calculation Logic	Value / user / month
Reference Value (Otter Pro)	Baseline equivalent subscription price	\$8.50
AI Exam-Oriented Study Notes (+)	WhisperNotes converts lecture transcripts into exam-focused notes (key points, definitions, formulas). Saves ~6 hours/month of manual re-writing & organizing. (6 hrs × \$12.5/hr).	+\$75
Flashcard Automation (+)	Automates creation of 5–10 flashcards per lecture. Saves ~3 hours/month. (3 hrs × \$12.5).	+\$37.5
Personalized Quiz Generation (+)	Reduces exam prep time by generating tailored quizzes. Saves ~4 hours/month. (4 hrs × \$12.5)	+\$50
Reduced Revision Time (+)	WhisperNotes organizes content by concepts, topics, and definitions. Saves ~2 hours/month. (2 hrs × \$12.5)	+\$25

Replaces Multiple Study Apps (+)	Avoided monthly cost of Quizlet (\$8), Notion AI pages (\$5), audio note apps (\$3).	+\$16
Minor AI Cleanup Cost (–)	Occasional need to correct small summary/transcription errors. (–2 hrs × \$12.5)	–\$25
Total	\$187.00 per student per month	

The survey results

Survey results reinforce both the significance of the problem and the market's readiness. Most respondents still depend on manual or semi-manual note-taking and express fatigue with repetitive rewriting and exam prep. Although a majority have never used a digital note-taking or transcription tool, most say they are likely or very likely to try an AI-powered solution like WhisperNotes.. This mix of high pain and low existing adoption indicates a substantial latent demand that a well-designed product could capture quickly.

The conjoint analysis quantifies how students trade off features and price. Price is the single most influential attribute overall, but among *non-price* attributes, Summary Quality has the largest impact on utility, followed by Slide Synchronization and then Sample Quiz Generation. This pattern indicates that students primarily see WhisperNotes as a *learning enhancement tool* and according to the attribute importance chart, they care much more about high-quality, exam-oriented summaries and quizzes than about convenience features like automatic slide matching. Using the price coefficients to translate utils into dollars, the move from a bare-bones app to one that offers richer summaries, quizzes, and slide support yields an incremental differentiation value of about \$8–\$9 per user per month. In other words, relative to a simple note-taking baseline, students' revealed preferences in the conjoint imply they would be willing to pay roughly \$7–\$8 more per month for the full WhisperNotes feature bundle.

Complementing the preference-based perspective, the EVC provides an upper-bound estimate based on time saved and avoided costs. Using a reference subscription (e.g., Otter Pro at ~\$8.50/month) and adding the value of saved study hours, automated flashcards, personalized quizzes, reduced revision time, and consolidation of multiple study apps - minus occasional AI cleanup, the theoretical EVC is roughly \$187 per student per month. This high figure represents a conceptual upper bound, illustrating that, under reasonable assumptions about students' time, WhisperNotes could generate substantial monthly value, even though actual willingness-to-pay will be constrained by budgets and market norms.

Taken together, the conjoint-based differentiation value (~\$8–\$9/month above a basic app) and the much larger EVC estimate (\$187.00/month of total value created) paint a coherent picture. Students place clear incremental value on WhisperNotes' core learning features, and the product appears to create far more value than it would ever need to charge for. This supports a value-based pricing strategy with conservative list prices, likely in the single-digit to low double-digit range per month - while still leaving substantial

consumer surplus. Because WhisperNotes has near-zero marginal cost of replication, the firm can layer a freemium + versioning model on top of this: a free tier for adoption and virality and a reasonably priced standard tier that captures part of the \$8–\$9 incremental value.

Recommendation and Future Planning

Based on the data, the recommended strategy is to launch WhisperNotes with two pricing tiers reflecting the product's EVC and consumer heterogeneity.

- The **Free Plan** will include limited recording and summarization for trial use, encouraging adoption and word-of-mouth growth.
- The **Pro Plan** at approximately \$4.99 per month will unlock high-quality summaries with full access to contextual flashcards, quizzes, and offline features.

WhisperNotes should first prioritize improving the Summary Quality attribute, followed by developing quiz generation, and then focus on slide synchronization based on the attribute importance from the conjoint. At the same time, to encourage data collection, we propose offering a 50% discount on the Pro plan for users who sign up with a valid .edu email address.

In the longer term, WhisperNotes could evolve into a platform business, connecting students and educators through shared course templates or curated study packs. Such a transition would generate positive cross-side network effects, increase the platform's defensibility and enable data-driven personalization. Incorporating recommender-system logic could further individualize the learning experience by suggesting flashcards or practice quizzes based on a student's past performance, thereby improving retention.

Future experimentation should follow the A/B testing framework to optimize pricing, onboarding flow, and feature adoption. Early metrics should be defined following goal-driver-guardrail hierarchy:

- **Goal metric:** Semester-to-semester retention of paying users.
- **Driver metrics:** Lecture-to-note conversion rate, quiz completion, and weekly active use.
- **Guardrail metrics:** User-reported trust, privacy satisfaction, and summary accuracy.

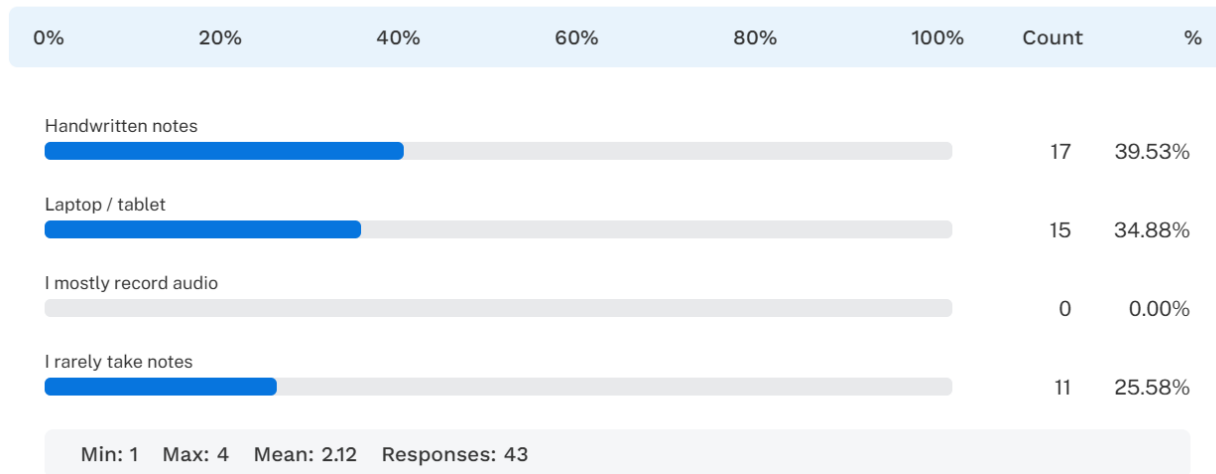
These metrics will enable WhisperNotes to test and scale responsibly while preserving the user experience.

In conclusion, the survey and conjoint evidence indicate a robust market opportunity for WhisperNotes. Students express strong unmet needs in note-taking efficiency and learning effectiveness, and the quantified EVC supports a sustainable pricing range of \$5 per month for the pro plan. By leveraging versioning, platform dynamics, and data-driven personalization, WhisperNotes can position itself as an indispensable academic companion and capture significant value in the emerging market for intelligent learning assistants.

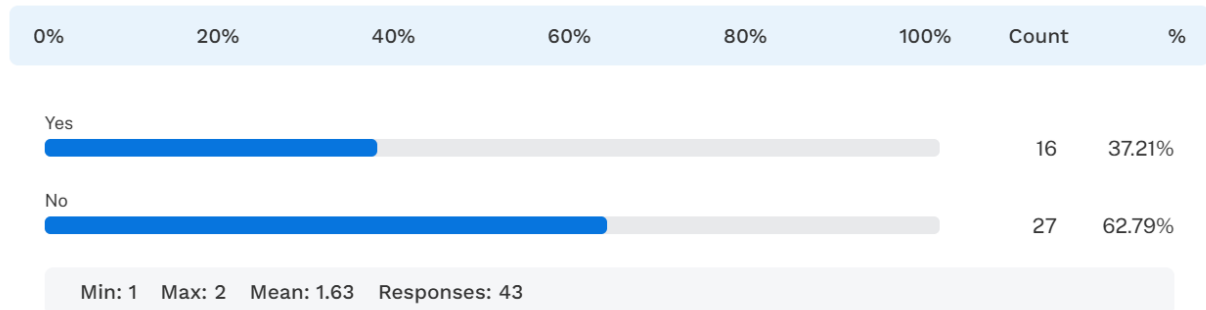
Appendix

Survey

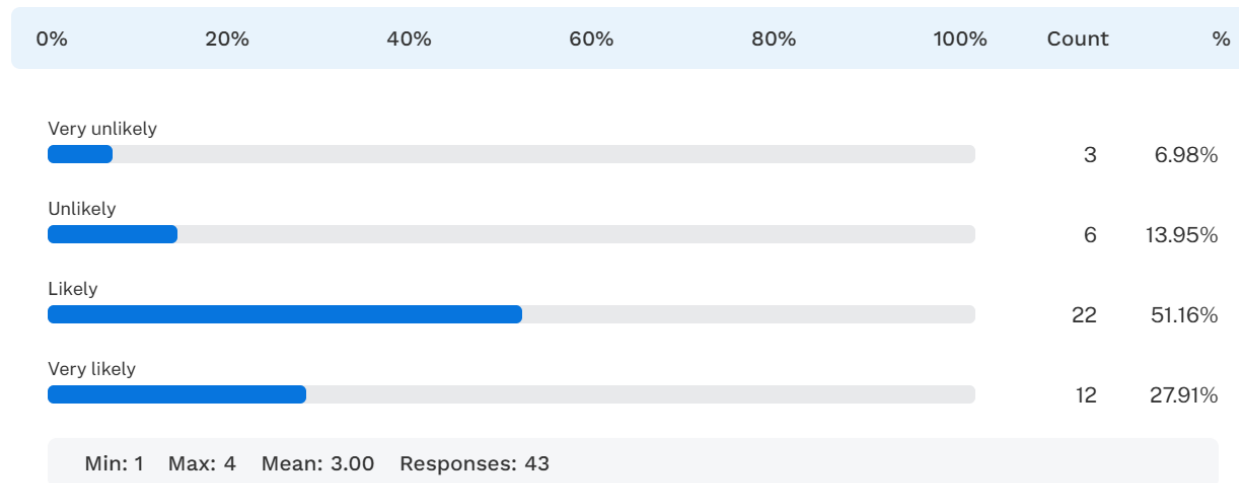
How do you usually take notes in lectures?



Have you used a digital note-taking or transcription app (e.g., Otter.ai, Notion, Notta)?

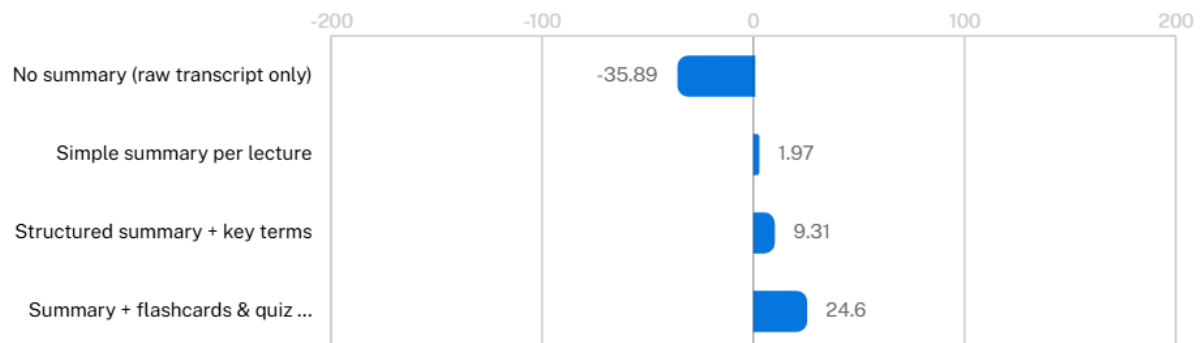


How likely are you to try an AI-powered note-taking app like this?



Conjoint

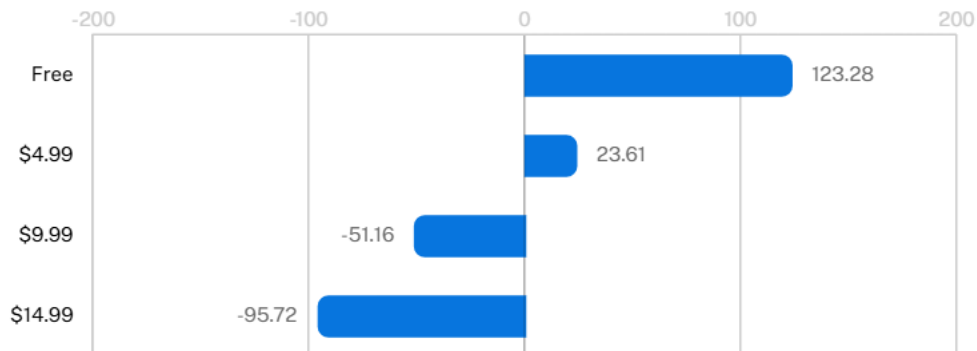
Summary Quality N=43



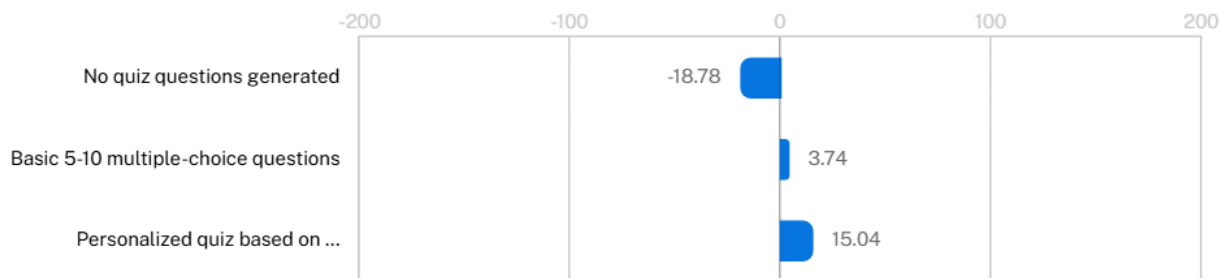
Slide Synchronization N=43



Monthly Price
N=43

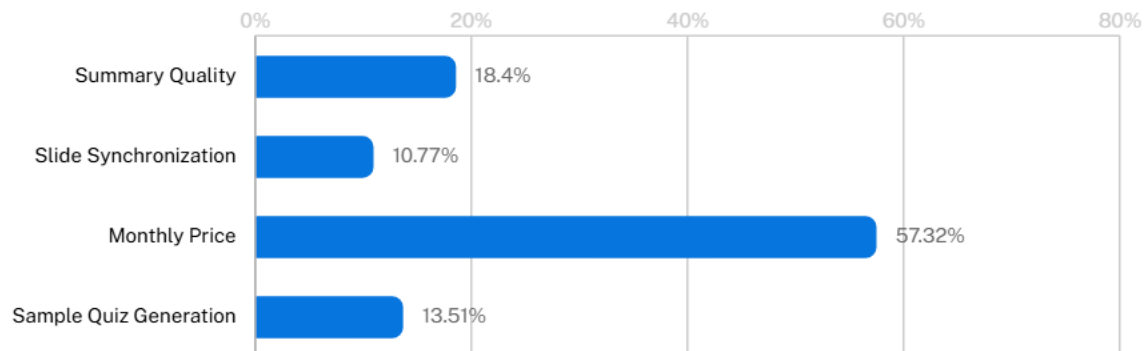


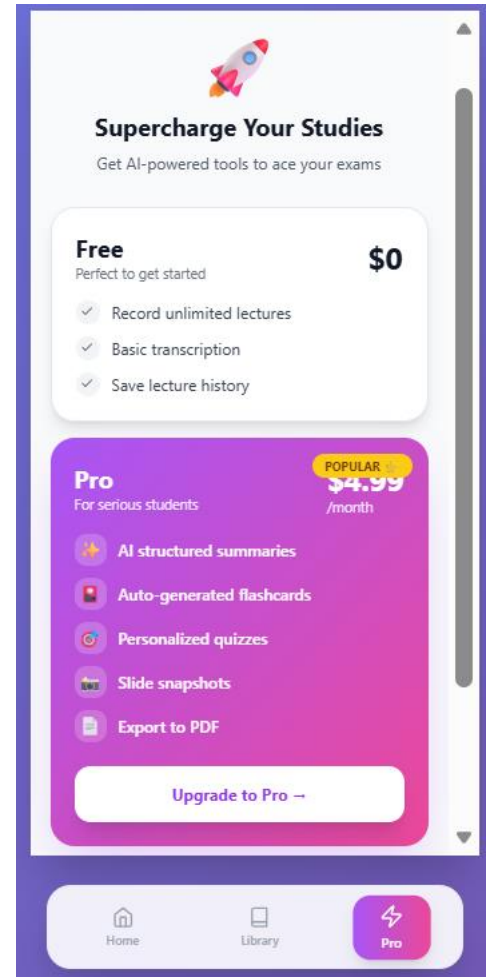
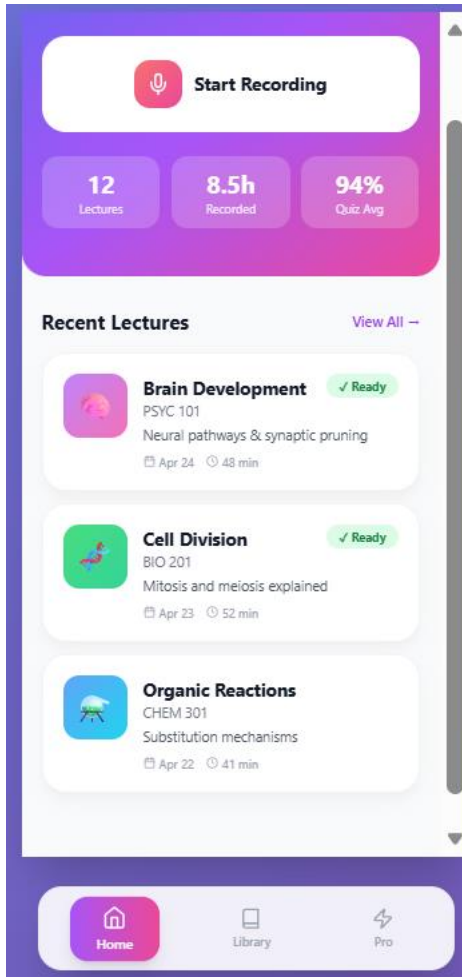
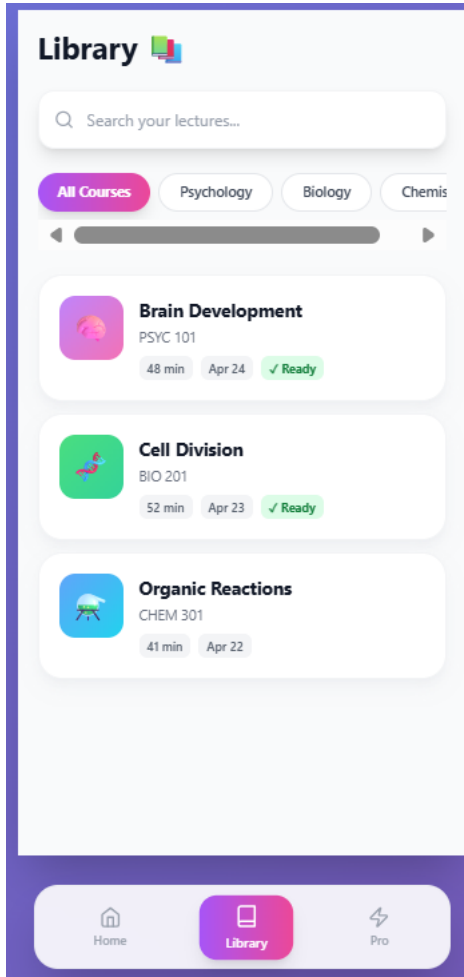
Sample Quiz Generation
N=43



Relative attribute importance

Attribute importance
N=43



WhisperNotes Concept Design



Brain Development

PSYC 101 • Neural Pathways

48 min Apr 24

Key Insights

- Early brain development involves overproduction and pruning of synapses
- Repeated activation strengthens specific neural pathways
- Environmental stimulation affects long-term cognitive outcomes

Key Terms

- Synaptic pruning
- Neural plasticity
- Critical period
- Neurogenesis



Flashcards

12 cards ready



Quiz

8 questions

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Flashcards

1/3

Synaptic pruning is the process where extra neurons and synaptic connections are eliminated to increase the efficiency of neuronal transmissions.

🤔 Need Review

😊 Got It!

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Quick Quiz

1/8

Which statement best describes neural plasticity?

A The brain's structure is fixed after childhood

B The brain can change in response to experience

C The number of neurons is constant

D None of the above

Next Question →